

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Ms Aisha Khan

Address: 41 Autumn Drive Sutton SM2 5BB

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: In my view, this represents a thoughtful and pragmatic re-use of a site that has long fulfilled a public function. It seems both logical and desirable for the premises to continue serving the community, rather than risk falling into vacancy or neglect. The proposal outlines a mixed-use community hub and place of worship, conceived not as a single-purpose venue but as a vibrant, multi-faceted space hosting regular activities for a broad cross-section of local residents.

Of particular merit is the emphasis on inclusive community provision set out in the submitted materials. The scheme proposes activities and support tailored to a range of groups, including children and young people, mothers and toddlers, and older residents, alongside wider community sessions open to all. Access to facilities of this nature within the borough offers tangible benefits: it enables residents to participate in organised activities and access support services locally, reducing the need to travel elsewhere for comparable opportunities.

On a personal level, my husband and I do not have relatives in the UK, and facilities of this kind are especially important to us. A centre such as this would provide a vital space in which to build strong social connections, feel supported, and develop meaningful relationships within the local community. Beyond individual benefit, it would also foster understanding, harmony, and positive interaction among people from diverse backgrounds, strengthening the social fabric of the area as a whole.

From a practical standpoint, the documentation indicates that due consideration has been given to site access and operational management, including parking arrangements, cycle storage, and strategies for managing busier periods. In my experience of the immediate area, traffic pressures

are largely concentrated around school drop-off and pick-up times in the early morning and mid-afternoon. Outside these peak windows, the surrounding roads are generally calmer, which suggests that routine community use is unlikely to generate significant traffic disruption.

Overall, I regard the proposal as a sensible and constructive use of an existing site, one that promises clear and meaningful community benefit. I therefore support Sutton Council granting approval.